

Remote Desktop Protocol (RDP) Session Limits & Disconnection Controls

RDP Session Timeout Rules: Enforce Group Policy Objects (GPO) or configuration limits for idle, active, and disconnected RDP sessions.

Introduction

RDP sessions left running in a disconnected or idle state consume system resources and remain vulnerable to session hijacking. Establishing strict RDP timeout policies ensures inactive sessions are logged off automatically.

Objectives

Aim: Configure Windows Group Policy or Linux `xrdp` session timeout policies to enforce automatic logoff for idle remote desktop users.

- Configure Idle Session Limit policies for remote desktop sessions.
- Set End Disconnected Session time thresholds.
- Audit session termination events in system log files.

Requirements

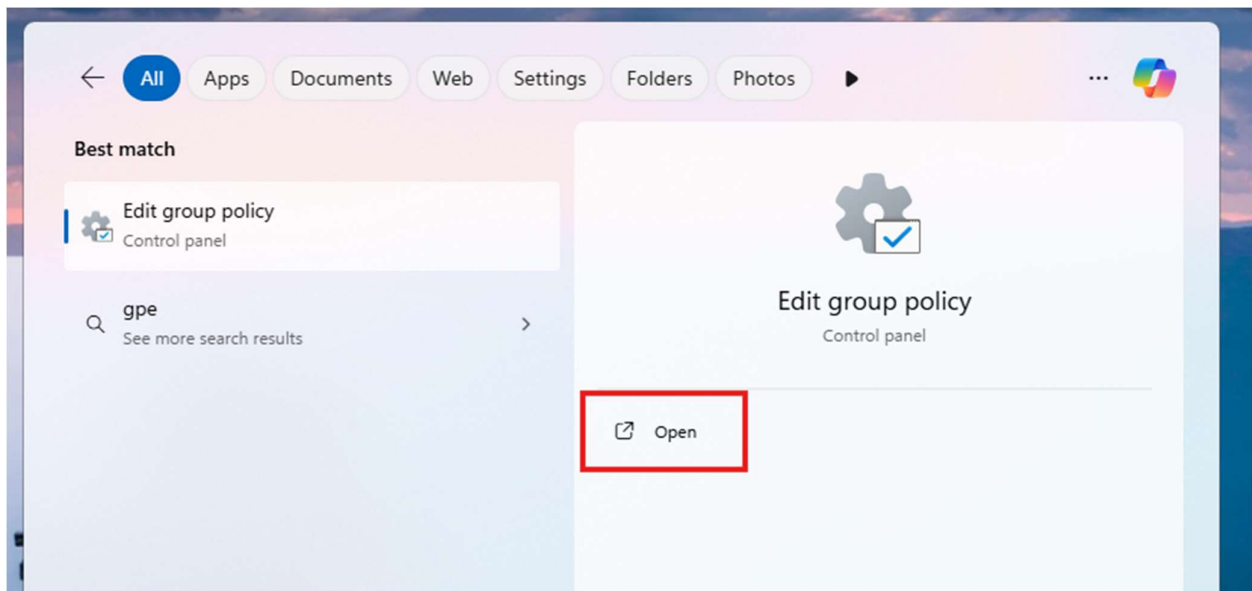
- Windows Host VM or Linux with `xrdp`.
- Administrative credentials to modify local security/group policies.

Expected Output

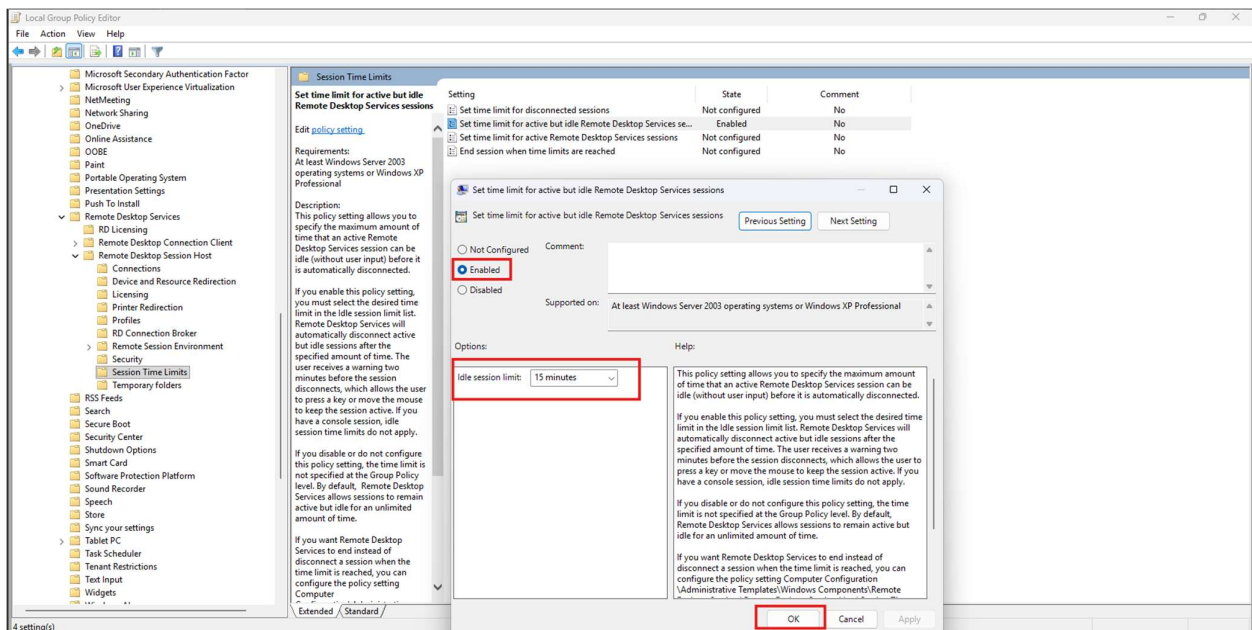
- Configured Local Group Policy Object enforcing 15-minute idle limit and 10-minute disconnected session end.
- System log recording forced session disconnect due to idle threshold breach.

Step by Step Procedure(s)

Step 1: Open Group Policy Editor by searching gpedit.msc from the Windows Search bar.



Step-2: Go to **Computer Configuration → Administrative Templates → Windows Components → Remote Desktop Services → Remote Desktop Session Host → Session Time Limits** and edit the required session timeout policies.



Step-3: Enable Disconnected Limit: Set 'End session when time limit is reached' to 'Enabled' and 'Set time limit for disconnected sessions' to '10 minutes'.

```
Administrator: Command Prompt
Microsoft Windows [Version 10.0.26200.8875]
(c) Microsoft Corporation. All rights reserved.

C:\Windows\System32>gpupdate /force
Updating policy...

Computer Policy update has completed successfully.
User Policy update has completed successfully.

C:\Windows\System32>ipconfig

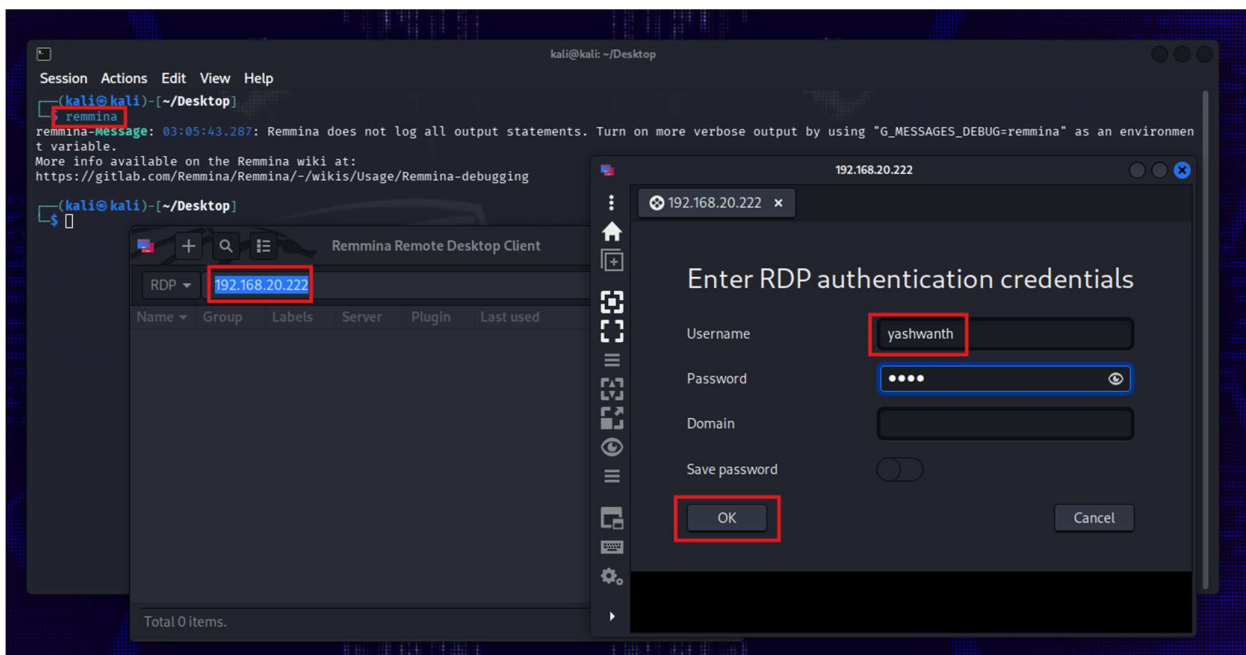
Windows IP Configuration

Ethernet adapter Ethernet0:

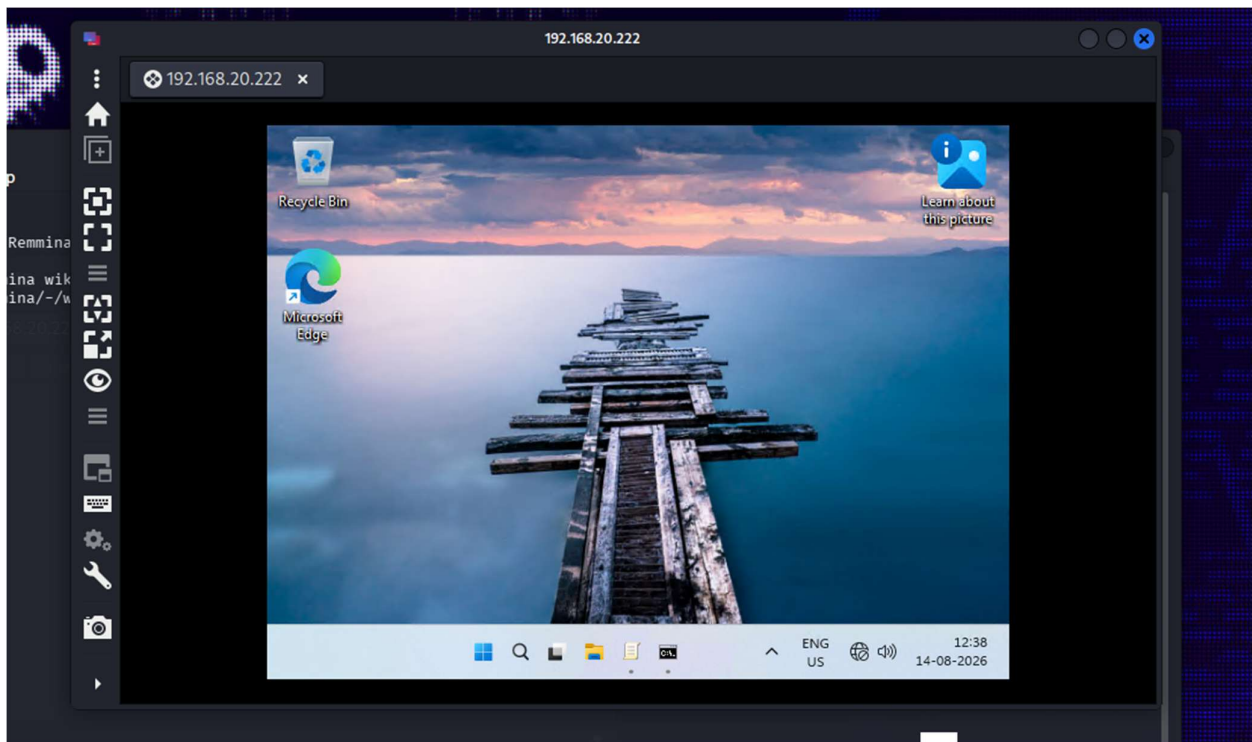
    Connection-specific DNS Suffix  . : 
    Link-local IPv6 Address . . . . . : fe80::f580:b1ff:8d5a:355c%14
    IPv4 Address. . . . . : 192.168.20.222
    Subnet Mask . . . . . : 255.255.255.0
    Default Gateway . . . . . : 192.168.20.1

C:\Windows\System32>
```

Step-4: Validate Policy Enforcement: Establish RDP connection, remain idle for 15 minutes, and observe system notification and logoff action.



Step-5: The RDP session logs in successfully, remains active for the configured **15-minute idle limit**, and then closes automatically.



Learning Outcomes

- Understand RDP session state management and timeout policies.
- Enforce security best practices for graphical remote desktop environments.

Notes/Observations

- Group Policy settings for RDP session timeout were configured successfully.
- The idle session limit was set to **15 minutes**.
- The disconnected session limit was set to **10 minutes**.
- The updated policies were applied successfully using `gpupdate /force`.
- RDP connection was established successfully through **Remmina** using Windows credentials.
- The RDP session was automatically terminated after the configured **15-minute idle period**.